Rules cheat sheet

Sacrament

Say what your hero does. The GM tells you whether to roll. Roll high, meet the Target, and mind the Horror.

YOUR SIX SCORES · ADDED TO THE D20

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
force, lifting, climbing, most melee	shooting, stealth, balance, fine work	endurance; part of your Defence	knowledge, searching, most spells	awareness, judgement, healing	persuasion, leadership, presence

A new hero shares **6 points** among the scores (none above 6) and **4 points** among the Effort bonuses below. Each advance adds one more point (page 3).

CHECKS · DO YOU SUCCEED?

d20 + score ≥ Target

- The GM sets the **Target**. Meet or beat it and you succeed.
- **Easy**: Target 3 lower. **Hard**: Target 3 higher. Agree it before you roll.
- A single bonus is never more than **+10**. The Target never drops below 1.

> The Target is 12. You roll 10 and add STR +3: 13. Success.

NATURAL ROLLS · WHAT THE DIE SHOWS

- **Natural 1**: adds **1 Horror** only on **magic** (a spell or a relic) or a **pushed** action, never on an ordinary attack or check. The total still decides whether you succeed.
- **Natural 20**: if the check succeeds, add one plain **d12** to the Effort roll, when your table uses that option.
- Neither one is an automatic success or failure for a hero. Only the total counts.

YOUR DEFENCE

- **Defence = 10 + CON + armour.** A foe must roll d20 + its attack bonus to reach it.
- Armour adds at most +5. CON and armour together, at most +10.

EFFORT · HOW MUCH, AFTER A SUCCESS

d4	d6	d8	d10	d12
BASIC	WEAPONS	GUNS	MAGIC	ULTIMATE
bare hands, basic work	blades, bows, crossbows, slings	guns and gunpowder	magical damage	a die, not a bonus: a natural 20 or a great power

Roll the die for that kind and add your Effort bonus in the same kind. Damage comes off HP; Effort against an obstacle fills its progress. **10 points = 1 Heart.** Your GM may change these dice; read your table's labels.

YOUR TURN, STEP BY STEP

1. Say what your hero does. Agree with the GM whether a check is needed, which score, and Easy or Hard.
2. Choose your target first, and the weapon, spell or item you use.
3. Roll **d20 + score** against the Target.
4. On a success, roll **Effort** for damage or progress.
5. On any failed roll you may **Push** (page 2).
6. Tell the GM you are done. The GM moves the turn on.

BREAK AWAY · LEAVE A FIGHT

- On your turn, instead of acting, make a **DEX check**. Success: you get clear and the foe does not attack you as you go. Failure: you stay put and it attacks as usual. A plain check, never pushed; the GM says where you can run.

WEAPON NOTES

- **Two-handed** weapons (heavy, reach, bows, crossbows, long guns): **+2 damage**, once (a critical too).
- **Crossbows**: Weapons d6, and a Move to reload. **Bows** keep your Move.
- **Guns** (rare): Guns d8, a Move to reload, loud. On a **natural 1 to 3** the powder fails and the shot misses.
- **Reach** weapons also keep the reach or control they describe. The GM resolves those.
- No item? An unarmed attack uses **Basic d4**.

HIT POINTS

- A new hero has **10 HP** (one Heart), plus any Hearts their gear grants.

When it goes wrong

PUSH · ONE MORE TRY, AT A PRICE

- After **any failed roll**: an attack, a spell, a check. Breaking away and crawling away cannot be pushed.
- Once, on your own turn. It adds **1 Horror** and gives you an immediate second action: try again, or do something else.
- The second action cannot be pushed. It gives no extra Move and does not reload a crossbow.

THE HORROR · ONE METER FOR THE WHOLE TABLE

Casting any non-healing spell, even if the check fails	**+1**
Casting a healing spell	**0**
A relic or other item (a relic of your own **path** costs 1 less, never below 1)	**its listed cost**
A hero's natural 1 on magic or a pushed action	**+1**
Taking a Push	**+1**
Acting anyway while dying	**+1**

Costs stack: a non-healing spell that rolls a natural 1 adds 2.

0	1	2	3	4	5	6	**7**	8	9	10	11	12	13	**14**	15	16	17	18	19	20	**21**

Each strikes **once an adventure** (the adventure's own lines first). **7**: every hero is **shaken**, their next roll Hard. **14**: foes met from then on have **+2 HP**. **21**: **no more rest**. Past 21 you **pay in blood**, **1 HP** a point (not for the GM's raises).

EQUIPMENT

- **10 equipped slots** and **10 pack slots**. Each item lists its size.
- Only **equipped** weapons, armour, relics and grimoires work. Supplies work from the pack.
- One body armour, one helmet and one shield at a time. A two-handed weapon needs the shield packed.
- At most **3 items that tempt the Horror** (relics, grimoires, curios), packed ones included.
- **Path** (optional), such as Priest, Scholar or Cutpurse: once a scene a check that fits it is **Easy** (the GM judges; not attacks), and its relics cost 1 less Horror.
- Ask the GM before swapping gear mid-fight.

GRIMOIRES AND SPELLS

- Every grimoire takes **3 slots** and holds **3 spells**. You may choose one to start with; the GM gives the rest.
- Most spells check **INT**; healing checks **WIS**. Read each spell for its range, effect and Horror.
- **Damage** and **Healing** spells change HP. **Esoteric** spells (light, movement, influence) are described, and the GM rules on them.
- A **once-per-scene** power is spent when you try it, even on a miss. Resting does not bring it back.

HEALING

- **Bandages** (Close): a WIS check heals **d6**. You cannot bandage yourself while dying.
- **Mend**: a WIS check heals **d8**. No Horror for casting it.
- **Healing relics**: their own dice and Horror cost.
- Each healing spell or item can heal a hero **once between rests**; a hero at 0 HP can always be healed.
- Healing never goes past maximum HP and never raises the dead.

DOWN TO 0 HP · DYING

- You have **3 rounds**. Each new round takes one off; at 0 you die.
- On your turn: **crawl away** (a CON check, free), or **pay 1 Horror** to act anyway.
- A hit while you are down takes a round off instead of damage.
- An ally can **Tend** you with bandages: an **Easy WIS** check makes you **Stable** (a natural 20 also heals d4). Hit again while Stable: 3 rounds again.
- Any healing of 1 HP or more puts you back on your feet.

PARTY REST · WHEN THE GM ALLOWS IT

- Every living hero heals **10 HP**, and healing allowances refresh.
- Horror falls by **one d6**. Once it has reached 21, no more rest this adventure.
- Spent supplies stay spent. The dead stay dead.

DISTANCE · NO GRID NEEDED

Close	Near	Far	Very Far
sword's reach	up to 30 feet, a throw	beyond 30 feet: bows, guns	longbow, rifle, or says so

Story, growth and the GM

STORY SPELLS AND ITEMS · WHEN THE WORDS LEAVE IT OPEN

Many spells and relics have no damage die: their words say what happens. Each carries one or two **tags**. **The spell's or item's own words always come first**; the tag is the quick answer when they leave it to the GM. The cost does not change: the same Horror, and the same check where the words ask for one.

TAG	IN A FIGHT	OUT OF A FIGHT
Light	—	Lights a dark place: a WIS check to search or notice there is no longer Hard.
Snuff	**Stop**: a foe of fire, or carrying it, loses its next attack.	Puts out ordinary flames.
Open	—	Opens or brings down a lock, door, seal, chain, cage or wall.
Learn	Your next attack against the foe is Easy.	Learns one true thing: a place's secret, a clue or the way on.
Hide	**Hinder**: the foe's next attack rolls 3 less.	Slips past a watcher or a sleeper unseen.
Silence	**Stop**: a foe that casts or calls out loses its next attack.	Stops a cry, a bell or an alarm.
Bind	**Stop**: the foe loses its next attack, only after a successful check.	Holds something falling, closing or charging, or freezes or tangles a crossing.
Daze	**Hinder**: the foe is Dazed, its next attack rolls 3 less.	—
Guard	+2 Defence until your next turn.	—
Beast	**Hinder**: an animal's next attack rolls 3 less.	Calms, asks or borrows the senses of an animal.
Move	—	Gets past a gap, a wall or brambles without crossing them.
Shelter	—	Keeps off bitter cold, foul water, hunger, or the dead rising in a cursed place.

Out of a fight, a fitting tag is one more way past an obstacle or a danger, as the GM judges. *The Last Verse* and *Its Real Name* have no tag: they stay the GM's call.

DARKNESS

- Without a light, a **WIS check to search or notice** in a dark place is **Hard** (+3).
- Nothing else changes by itself: anything more the dark does is the GM's call.

GROWING STRONGER

☐ ☐ ☐ Tick **1 mark** for each adventure your hero lives through to its end.

- At **3 marks**, take one advance: **+1 to one score** (up to 6) or **+1 to one Effort bonus** (up to +10). The marks start again.
- Each advance adds one point to the hero's share, so a grown hero can join any table.

THE GM'S SIDE

- **Monster attacks:** d20 + Attack bonus against the hero's Defence. A monster's **natural 1 always misses** and its **natural 20 always hits**. Monsters' natural 1s add no Horror.
- **Turns:** only the GM moves the turn on. A new round ticks every countdown and every dying hero once. Outside a hero's turn, only the GM can allow a Push.
- **7, 14, 21:** once an adventure each; a new adventure resets them. **Paths:** you judge what fits.
- **Party rest:** the GM decides when a place and time allow it.
- **The GM rules on** movement, range and sight, cover, ammunition and reloading, Guard, Assist, conditions such as Dazed, and anything an item describes in words.

HOUSE RULES · AGREE THEM BEFORE YOU PLAY

- **Natural 20 d12** (on unless the table switches it off): a successful natural 20 adds one plain d12 to the damage or Effort roll.
- **Scene danger** (off unless the table switches it on): monster attacks add the Target minus 11, if above 0. Target 12 adds +1; Target 14 adds +3.
- **Effort dice:** the GM may change which die each kind rolls. Read your table's labels.